

Chapter 1: Mass Desire: The Force that Makes Advertising Work - And How to Focus It Onto Your Product

In Chapter 1 of *Breakthrough Advertising*, Gene Schwartz wastes zero time in getting directly to the heart of what makes advertising work.

He says “*Copy cannot create desire for a product. It can only take the hopes, dreams, fears and desires that already exist in the hearts of millions of people, and focus those already existing desires onto a particular product.*”

This is the main point of Chapter 1. Every subsequent point in *Breakthrough Advertising* flows from this understanding of the copywriters REAL job.

How to Channel Mass Desire Onto Your Particular Product

You can find this section starting on page 7.

The copywriter uses three tools to channel mass desire:

First, he uses his own knowledge of people's hopes and dreams.

Second, he has the product. And third is the advertising message that connects the market's desire with the product.

The copywriter performs his work in three stages:

1. Choose the most powerful desire that can possibly be applied to your product.
 - a. **Every mass desire has 3 dimensions:**
 - i. Urgency, intensity, degree of demand to be satisfied
 - ii. Staying power, the degree of repetition, the inability to become satiated
 - iii. Scope. The number of people who share this desire.
2. Acknowledge that desire - reinforce it - and/or offer the means to satisfy it -- in a single statement in the headline of your ad.
3. Then take the series of performances that are built into your product - what your product does - and you show your prospect how these performances inevitably satisfy that desire.
 - a. **Every product you sell is actually TWO products:**
 - i. One of them is the physical product - the steel, glass, paper. What it IS.

- ii. The other is the functional product - the product in action - the series of benefits that your product performs for your consumer. (**NOTE:** this is also referred to as the product's *performance* later in this chapter and others.)

Your customer buys what the product DOES (ie: the function or performance)

The physical product can only justify the price or document the quality of a product's performance.

Products can have dozens of performances, but you can only feature ONE in your ad.

You must pick the performance that best channels the market's dominant desire onto your product.

Exercise and Application

Based on Chapter 1, there are two actions every marketer must take if they want to apply what Gene is talking about here.

First, you must uncover the dominant desire in your market.

Markets have multiple desires. Your job is to find the one that is DOMINANT.

I show you how in Exercise 1 below.

Second, you must map the performance of your product to the market's dominant desire.

See Exercise 2 to see how you can do this.

Exercise 1: Discovering Your Market's Dominant Desire

Using the resources in the links below, list the desires of your market. Then rank them across the three dimensions outlined in Chapter 1: urgency, staying power and scope.

NOTE: In our **Breakthrough Advertising Quickstart Bootcamp**, we provided two different frameworks for uncovering a market's desire. Members found these frameworks helpful and I want to share them with you too.

You can find the worksheet below along with a brief explanation at breakthroughadvertisingbook.com/resources

Market's Desire - "I want to..."	So I can...	So I can	So I can...	Dimensions				Score
				Urgency (1-5)	Staying Power (1-5)	Scope (1-5)		
								0
								0
								0
								0
								0
								0
								0
								0
								0
								0

Visit breakthroughadvertisingbook.com/resources to access

Exercise 2: Mapping Product Performance to Dominant Desire

Once you know your market's dominant desire you are ready for the next step.

You need to list out all the performances found in your product (what it *DOES*), then map those performances to your list of market desires from exercise 1.

You are looking for the performance that satisfies the dominant desire.

We've provided a worksheet for this exercise along with instructions at breakthroughadvertisingbook.com/resources

Product Name	Feature (what it is)	Why is this feature included?	Your product in action	Your product in action	Fear, Shame, Guilt, Glad, Sad, Anger, Hurt, Lonely	What is the matching desire in the market?
			Performance/Benefit ("so you can...")	Benefit of the Benefit ("so you can...")		

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